

REQUEST FOR PROJECT APPROVAL

Submit this form along with:



Lender's credit presentation and financial analysis including 2 years of projections.



Qualifying characteristic documentation if the borrower qualifies as a **veteran** or an individual who is **low-income** or **disabled**.

Request

Lender: NEON Business Finance ELP amount requested: \$125,000.00

Operating Company

Business legal name: IAZ Corporation

Assumed name (if applicable): Minuteman Press Uptown

Project street address: 4024 Washington Avenue North

Project city: Minneapolis Project zip: 55412 Project county: Hennepin

Business legal structure: ☐ LLC ☒ Corporation ☐ Sole Proprietorship

Product/Service: Commercial Printing

NAICS Code (6-Digit): 323111

Real Estate (complete only if ELP funds will be used for real property purchase or improvements on property owned by the operating company or a related party)

Real estate ownership:

☐ Owner(s) individually ☐ Holding company ☐ Operating company

Percentage of real estate occupied by operating company: _____

If real estate not owned by the operating company, how is operating company tied to the loan?



Co-Borrower



Corporate Guarantor

If real estate owned by a holding company:

Holding company name: _____

Owner(s) and ownership percentages: _____

Operating Company Ownership

Primary business contact: Frank Brown Title: President

Ownership percentage: 51%

Phone number: 6127437653 Email: fbrown@mpuptown

Other owners (over 20%) and percentages owned:

Julie Brown / 49%

☒ Business is owned and operated by individuals who collectively own at least 51% of the business. (See qualifying characteristics definitions on pages 7-8.)

Qualifying characteristic(s) of business owner/operator(s). Check all that apply.

☒ BIPOC / Minority ☒ Woman ☐ Veteran ☐ Low-Income ☐ Person with Disability

Owner demographics: Use this [Demographic Form link](#) to provide information for the majority owner of the business. This is a required form.

☒ Borrower has completed the demographics form.

Owner background relevant to project:

☐ Included in credit presentation

ELP Loan Details

☒ Conventional term loan ☐ Profit-based financing (borrower prohibitions on interest)

Date loan was approved by lender: 9/12/2025

Total Amount of Note: \$250,000

Monthly payment: \$312.50 IO / \$2,246.09 FA

Term (inc. interest-only payments): 60 months

Interest-only period (if applicable): 12 months

Amortization (if longer than term): _____

Interest rate or profit equivalent: 3%

Origination fee - ELP portion: \$1,250.00

Collateral type: Business Assets

Lien position: 2nd

Guarantees: ☒ Personal ☐ Corporate

Project

Brief project description (e.g., Working capital to help business with marketing and increasing staff):

Working capital to support hiring new staff.

Why is traditional (i.e., bank) financing not available, making state participation required for the project to move forward?

The company has experienced rapid growth, which has been financed with debt. Traditional banks consider the amount of current debt on the books to be too high for their risk tolerance. We received conditional approval for the Loan Committee in September but could not close until senior lender approved the additional debt on September 10, 2025. Borrower approached some banks but was unable to qualify because of the current debt load. Under a traditional bank loan, the borrower's debt coverage ratio would have been below 1 given the current interest rate banks are charging for business loans. Using low interest capital, NEON was able to meet MEDA's requirement that the business maintain a 1.25 DCR with the additional debt. NEON closed on September 12, 2025, but the loan was not funded until the 17th.

Proposed Sources and Uses (include all recent or expected financing)

This must match the Lender's Credit Write-Up.

	Lender		Bank	Equity	Other (e.g., City):	Total
	ELP	Non-ELP				
Property Acquisition						0
Construction / Remodeling						0
Leasehold Improvements						0
Furniture / Fixtures						0
Equipment						0
Inventory						0
Working Capital	\$125000	125000				250000
Other: _____						0
Other: _____						0
Other: _____						0
Total Project	125000	125000	0	0	0	250000

Business Stage and Matching Funds (choose A or B)

(A) Beginning microenterprises with ELP request not more than \$40,000 (or \$55,000 in low-income area). **No private matching funds required.**

- ☐ Startup organized less than two years ago AND with fewer than 5 employees.
- ☐ Startup organized more than two years ago, but generating revenue less than two years, AND with fewer than 5 employees.

Date revenue began: _____

Tax return for _____ (year) attached as evidence that revenue was not being generated more than two years ago.

(B) Established business OR startup with at least 5 employees or ELP request above \$40,000 (\$55,000 in low-income area). Retail businesses not eligible under this category. **Private matching funds required.**

- ☐ Match will come from an inherently non-governmental source (e.g., bank loan or owner's equity.)
- ☒ Match will be provided by a nonprofit lender from a private source (e.g., internal loan fund or foundation grant). May include recourse funds from any source (i.e., repayment required regardless of whether borrower defaults).

Source of matching funds: NEON / Groundbreak Coalition

Employment

Enter how many employees did the company employ at the date the loan was approved by the lender:

1 owner(s) 16 full-time employees 0 part-time employees

After the loan is closed, the company expects to create the following new jobs (do not include owner(s)):

Job Title	Number of Positions	Hourly Wage	Full-Time or Part-Time	Anticipated Hiring Date
Signage Customer Service	1	20.00	FT	9/29/2025

LENDER CERTIFICATIONS

PUBLIC DATA

If the project is approved, the information contained in the application will become a matter of public record with the exception of those items protected under the Minnesota Government Data Practices Act found in Minnesota Statutes, Chapter 13.

RESOURCE SHARING

The lender is required to share information about the following State of Minnesota resources to the borrower whose loan is expected to be funded at least in part by the Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program:

1. **Targeted Group / Economically Disadvantaged / Veteran-Owned (TG/ED/VO) Small Business Procurement Program.** This procurement program is available through the Materials Management Division of the Minnesota Department of Administration. Details of the program can be found [here](#) with additional details in Minnesota Rules, Chapter 1230.
2. **MinnesotaWorks.net.** Businesses or private enterprises seeking to hire for positions in Minnesota may list any vacant or new positions with [MinnesotaWorks.net](#). The employer may also enlist the services of the Workforce Center Business Services staff to recruit and refer job candidates.
3. **Work Opportunity Tax Credit.** The Work Opportunity Tax Credit is a federal tax credit available to all private sector businesses as an incentive to employers to hire workers in certain groups who consistently experience high rates of unemployment. Details can be found [here](#).

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

The lender must certify the following:

- No employee or director or immediate family member of an employee or director of the lender has any personal financial interest in the qualifying small business for which project approval under the Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program is being sought.
- The lender will promptly notify DEED if and when an event occurs that renders this Conflict of Interest Certification obsolete or inaccurate.

For the purposes of this certification the following terms have the meanings set forth below:

- “Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program” means the program administered by DEED that is created by MN Laws 2016, Chapter 189, Article 7, Section 37.
- “Immediate family member” means a spouse, domestic partner, parent, sibling, child, in-law, or other relative living in the home.
- “Personal financial interest” means any financial interest, whether direct or indirect, that is derived from ownership, right to ownership of, or investment in the qualifying small business.

LENDER CERTIFICATION

By signing below, the lender makes the following certifications to the Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development (DEED):

Resource Sharing Certification: I hereby certify that I have shared the resource information listed above with the borrower who will receive funds through the Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program.

Conflict of Interest Certification: I hereby certify that the lender does not have a conflict of interest as defined above.

To the best of my knowledge, the data and analysis in this Request for Project Approval is correct and complete. I agree to supply the information in this Request for Project Approval to the Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development, Office of Business Finance with full knowledge of the information provided herein. I certify the information contained herein is true and accurate.

Larry E. Posey / Loan Officer

Name/Title of Lender Authorized Representative

Larry E. Posey

9/25/2025

Signature of Lender Authorized Representative

Date

BUSINESS CERTIFICATIONS

DATA PRIVACY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

Tennessee Warning Notice: per MN Statutes 13.04, Subd.2, this data is being requested from you to determine if you are eligible for assistance from the Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development. You are not required to provide the requested information, but failure to do so may result in the department's inability to determine your eligibility for assistance. The data you provide that is classified as private or non-public and will not be shared without your permission except as specified in state and federal laws.

Data Privacy Notice: per MN Statutes 13.591, Subdivision 1, certain data provided in this Application is private or non-public data; this includes financial information about the business, including credit reports, financial statements, net worth calculations, business plans; income and expense projections; balance sheets; customer lists; income tax returns; and design, market, and feasibility studies not paid for with public funds. Per MN Statutes 116J.401, Subd. 3., certain data provided in this application is private data; this includes data collected on individuals pursuant to the operation of business finance programs.

OWNER/OPERATOR QUALIFYING CHARACTERISTICS

In order to qualify for program funds, the business must be majority (at least 51%) owned and operated by persons who meet certain qualifying characteristics. One or more individuals may be included when determining eligibility. Please provide information regarding qualifying characteristics of the owner(s)/operator(s). **Check all that apply:**



Minority

Minority group members are citizens (or lawfully admitted permanent residents) of the United States who belong to one or more of the following groups:

- (i) "Black Americans," which includes persons having origins in any of the Black racial groups of Africa;
- (ii) "Hispanic Americans," which includes persons of Mexican, Puerto Rican, Cuban, Dominican, Central or South American, or other Spanish or Portuguese culture or origin, regardless of race;
- (iii) "Native Americans," which includes persons who are American Indians, Eskimos, Aleuts, or Native Hawaiians;
- (iv) "Asian-Pacific Americans," which includes persons whose origins are from Japan, China, Taiwan, Korea, Burma (Myanmar), Vietnam, Laos, Cambodia (Kampuchea), Thailand, Malaysia, Indonesia, the Philippines, Brunei, Samoa, Guam, the U.S. Trust Territories of the Pacific Islands (Republic of Palau), the Commonwealth of the Northern Marianas Islands, Macao, Fiji, Tonga, Kiribati, Juvalu, Nauru, Federated States of Micronesia, or Hong Kong;
- (v) "Subcontinent Asian Americans," which includes persons whose origins are from India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, the Maldives Islands, Nepal or Sri Lanka;



Low-income person

Low-income person means a person whose income is less than or equal to 80% of median income for their county of residence adjusted for family size.



Woman

☐ Veteran

Veteran means a citizen of the United States or a resident alien who has been separated under honorable conditions from any branch of the armed forces of the United States after having served on active duty for 181 consecutive days or by reason of disability incurred while serving on active duty, or who has met the minimum active duty requirement as defined by Code of Federal Regulations, title 38, section 3.12a, or who has active military service certified under section 401, Public Law 95-202. The active military service must be certified by the United States secretary of defense as active military service and a discharge under honorable conditions must be issued by the secretary.

☐ Person(s) with disabilities

The term "disability" is defined under the Americans with Disabilities Act and means, with respect to an individual:

- (A) a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities of such individual;
- (B) a record of such an impairment; or
- (C) being regarded as having such an impairment.

BUSINESS CERTIFICATION

Financial Assistance Certification: I hereby certify that the Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program is necessary to my business start-up or expansion and that without the Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program my business start-up or expansion project would not happen to the extent outlined in the project proposal.

Qualifying Owner Certification: I certify that the business is at least 51% owned and operated by person(s) who are representative of one or more of the qualifying groups.

I have read the above statements and agree to supply the information provided herein for the purpose of enrolling this project in the Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program. I agree that my business will work with job referral networks that focus on minority and low-income applicants. I further agree to provide additional information requested from time to time by the enrolled Minnesota Emerging Entrepreneur Loan Program lender such that the enrolled lender may complete reporting to the Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development, Office of Business Finance. I certify that all information provided herein is true and accurate and that the official signing this form has authorization to do so.

Frank Brown

President

Name/Title of Authorized Business Representative


[Frank Brown \(Oct 10, 2025 16:56:48 CDT\)](#)

10/10/2025

Signature of Authorized Business Representative

Date